

AYE
FIT HUB

• HIT • DAY 9

Tabata Training

4 Minutes That Change Everything

Day 9 of 30 | High-Intensity Interval Training

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- 20/10 Tabata protocol explained
- 3 full Tabata blocks
- Effort scoring system

01 | The Origin of Tabata — From Ice Hockey to the World

In 1996, Japanese scientist Dr. Izumi Tabata published a study comparing two groups: one doing 60 minutes of moderate cardio, the other doing 4-minute Tabata intervals. After 6 weeks, the Tabata group had improved both aerobic capacity (VO₂ max) AND anaerobic capacity. The moderate cardio group improved aerobic capacity only. **4 minutes beat 60 minutes** — in half the categories.

The protocol is brutally simple: **20 seconds maximum effort, 10 seconds rest, repeated 8 times = 4 minutes**. One round. One exercise. Total devastation. When done correctly, it is one of the most effective fat-burning and conditioning tools in existence.

Protocol	Work	Rest	Rounds	Total Time	Intensity
HIIT (Day 2)	30 sec	30 sec	3–4	20 min	80–90% max HR
Tabata (today)	20 sec	10 sec	8	4 min/block	90–100% max HR
EMOM (Day 15)	X reps	Remainder	10–20	10–20 min	75–90% max HR

■ INFO — 10 Seconds Is Not Enough Rest. That Is the Point.

The 10-second rest in Tabata is deliberately insufficient. Your body cannot recover fully, so each round starts with accumulated fatigue. This is what forces adaptation in both energy systems simultaneously. If 10 seconds feels like enough — you are not going hard enough on the 20-second intervals.

02 | How to Execute Tabata Correctly

Stage	What to Do	Common Mistake
Warm-up	At least 5 minutes. Tabata without warm-up risks muscle tearing	Skipping warm-up to "save time"
Round 1–2	Establish pace. Hold back 10% — you have 6 more rounds	Going 100% on round 1 and dying by round 5
Round 3–6	This is where the work happens. Maintain form under fatigue	Letting form break down to chase more reps
Round 7–8	Empty the tank. These rounds should feel near-impossible	Stopping early or taking extra rest
Rest between blocks	60–90 seconds minimum before the next 4-minute block	Starting the next block before HR drops below 130 bpm

■ ■ WARNING — Tabata Is Not for Every Day

Tabata taxes the central nervous system heavily. Maximum 2–3 Tabata sessions per week, never on consecutive days. Today is Day 9. Your next Tabata session will be Day 24 (Peak Phase). Between now and then, HIIT and EMOM formats provide sufficient intensity.

03 | Day 9 Workout — 3-Block Tabata Session

Format: 20 sec max effort / 10 sec rest × 8 rounds = 4 min per block | **Blocks:** 3 | **Rest between blocks:** 90 sec | **Total time:** ~25 min | **Equipment:** None

WARM-UP (5 min — mandatory for Tabata)

Exercise	Duration	Notes
Easy jog in place	90 sec	Gradually increase pace
Leg swings + arm swings	60 sec	30 sec each
Deep squat hold	30 sec	Hold bottom position, breathe
Hip circles	30 sec	Both directions
Explosive jumping jacks	60 sec	Build to 80% intensity — prime the system
10-sec sprint in place	30 sec	3 × (10 sec hard / 10 sec easy)

BLOCK A — Lower Body (20 sec on / 10 sec off × 8 rounds = 4 min)

Round	Exercise	Target Reps	Easier Option	Your Reps
1–2	Jump Squat	12–15	Bodyweight Squat	___ / ___
3–4	Jump Squat	10–13	Bodyweight Squat	___ / ___
5–6	Jump Squat	9–12	Bodyweight Squat	___ / ___
7–8	Jump Squat	MAX	Bodyweight Squat	___ / ___

BLOCK B — Upper Body (20 sec on / 10 sec off × 8 rounds = 4 min)

Round	Exercise	Target Reps	Easier Option	Your Reps
1–2	Push-Up	10–12	Knee Push-Up	___ / ___
3–4	Push-Up	8–10	Knee Push-Up	___ / ___
5–6	Push-Up	7–9	Knee Push-Up	___ / ___
7–8	Push-Up	MAX	Knee Push-Up	___ / ___

BLOCK C — Full Body (20 sec on / 10 sec off × 8 rounds = 4 min)

Round	Exercise	Target Reps	Easier Option	Your Reps
1–2	Burpee	6–8	Step-Back Burpee	___ / ___
3–4	Burpee	5–7	Step-Back Burpee	___ / ___
5–6	Burpee	5–6	Step-Back Burpee	___ / ___
7–8	Burpee	MAX	Step-Back Burpee	___ / ___

■ INFO — Effort Score System

After each block rate your effort 1–10. Block A target: 8–9/10. Block B: 8–9/10. Block C: 9–10/10. If you scored below 7 on any block, you held back too much. If you could not finish round 7 or 8, that is exactly right.

04 | Cool-Down + Tabata Quick Reference

COOL-DOWN (4 min)	
Exercise	Duration
Walk in place — slow HR down	90 sec
Standing quad stretch (each leg)	30 sec
Hip flexor lunge stretch (each side)	30 sec
Seated forward fold	45 sec
Lying spinal twist (each side)	30 sec
Deep breathing — 4 in / 4 hold / 6 out	45 sec

05 | Tabata Quick Reference Card

Rule	Guideline
Protocol	20 sec max effort / 10 sec rest × 8 rounds = 4 min per block.
Intensity required	90–100% max heart rate during the 20-sec work intervals.
Frequency	Max 2–3 times per week. Never two days in a row.
Minimum warm-up	5 minutes mandatory — Tabata without warm-up risks injury.
Rest between blocks	60–90 seconds. Let heart rate drop below 140 bpm.
Number of blocks	Beginners: 2 blocks. Intermediate: 3 blocks. Advanced: 4–6 blocks.
Exercise selection	Compound, full-body movements only — burpee, squat jump, push-up, mountain climber.
Know when to stop	Dizziness, chest pain, or unable to maintain any form = stop immediately.

06 | Day 9 Self-Check Question

Complete before Day 10.

"In which of the 3 blocks did you feel the biggest drop in reps from round 1 to round 8? What does that tell you about your weakest energy system — and what exercise will you use to target it this week?"

Your answer:

Next up — Day 10:
 Flexibility Fundamentals — Mobility for Athletes

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